

Membership plans for the Ethixweb dashboard

Clients can now choose a plan, pay for it, see what it unlocks, and change or cancel it themselves. Everything below is built, running, and checked by automated tests.

What a client can now do

This is the whole journey, in the order a real client goes through it. Every step works today.

Step	What happens
1. They get an email	The moment their account is made, they are emailed their dashboard link and the three plans with prices. Clients who were with us before plans existed get the same email the first time they sign in, with an extra line explaining why hosting now needs a plan. Sent once, never twice.
2. They pick a plan	On their first sign-in a window shows Unlimited \$29, Managed \$19 and Basic \$9, with a switch for monthly, 3, 6 or 12 months. Longer periods show the discount and the real monthly cost. It can be closed and never nags again; a quiet line at the top of the dashboard and a 'Plan' menu item are how they find it later.
3. We confirm payment	Their choice appears on a 'Waiting on payment' list on the admin Billing page with the exact amount to ask for. One button marks it paid. Nothing unlocks before that button is pressed.
4. They see what they got	Next time they open the dashboard, a window lists only the things that are new to them, each one a link to where it lives. They also get a confirmation email with the plan, amount, and renewal date.
5. They use it	Managed clients see '1 of 2 used this month'. Basic clients are told changes are not included and offered Managed. Everyone can always report an outage or ask about billing, whatever they pay.
6. They change or leave	Changing plan and cancelling are both one click from the Billing page. Cancelling is a single screen, and the plan keeps working until the period they paid for runs out.

Three rules that are enforced, not just displayed

- **Nothing unlocks until payment is confirmed.** Choosing a plan creates a record and changes nothing else.
- **A client is never on two plans at once.** The database itself refuses a second active plan, as well as the code.
- **Locked features are genuinely locked.** The server refuses the data, not just the screen. A locked panel shows clearly-marked examples so people can see what they would be buying — never made-up data presented as theirs.

What the existing clients experience on day one

Nothing is taken away from anyone. Every current client keeps full access until you decide otherwise — they are **asked** to choose a plan, never cut off. Turning on enforcement later is a single setting, not a code change.

Decisions built in as agreed

- Prices are USD only, exactly as the sales playbook prints them, including all twelve period prices and the discounts.
- Payment is handled manually: we send details, an admin confirms. The existing Stripe code was left completely untouched and still works.
- Managed's third change in a month is **not refused** — it is quoted and charged per job, or saved until the allowance resets. Nothing the client typed is ever lost.
- Upgrading mid-period credits the unused days. Downgrading is scheduled for the period end so nobody loses money they already paid.
- Upgrade suggestions are capped at one a week, dropping to one a month after three refusals, and never appear while somebody is writing a request.

How this was checked, and what is left

Automated tests

1,384 automated checks pass and none fail. Anyone can confirm this by opening the project folder and running one command:

```
npm test
```

Test file	Checks	What it proves
scripts/test-plans.js	153	Every price, discount and plan feature matches the printed sales playbook.
scripts/test-membership.js	59	The new database tables behave: money stays money, no duplicate counters, no double plans.
scripts/test-app.js	811	End to end through real web requests: choosing, paying, unlocking, limits, prompts, cancelling.
4 existing test files	361	Everything that worked before still works. None of these needed changing.

Checked by hand in a real browser

Every screen was opened and used in a browser, at desktop and phone size, in light and dark mode: the plan window, billing page, admin payment list, unlock window, ticket limit, locked panels, upgrade prompt, cancel page, and the Terms and Privacy pages. All three emails were sent to real inboxes and revised twice on feedback.

Seven real faults found and fixed during the work

Listed because finding them is the evidence the work was genuinely exercised, not assumed.

- Choosing a plan would have **taken a client's dashboard away** until an admin confirmed payment.
- Downgrading credited about \$49 against a \$9 plan and **silently destroyed the other \$40**.
- Two date fields were being turned into the text 'NaN', which would have shown on a client's billing page.
- The 'what you unlocked' window **vanished a second after opening**.
- The upgrade window opened hidden behind another window and used up the week's one allowed prompt.
- The 'choose a plan' window popped up **the instant somebody cancelled**.
- Money we were owed displayed as '-\$96.90', which reads as a refund.

Size of the work

	Count	Detail
New files	33	About 6,500 lines: plan rules, database, endpoints, screens, tests.
Changed files	25	About 2,600 lines added. Nothing deleted, no existing screen rebuilt.
Database	4 tables	Plus 7 optional fields. Nothing removed or rewritten.
Emails and pages	3 and 4	Welcome, confirmation, renewal. Plans, cancel, Terms, Privacy.

What the team still needs to do

Two small jobs. Neither needs a developer.

- **Fill in four settings.** The sender name and reply-to address on emails, the company postal address for the footer, and the payment mode. These are typed into the server settings, not the code.
- **Have a lawyer read the Terms and Privacy pages.** They are written to describe exactly what the product does, and both are clearly marked 'Draft, for internal review' at the top until that happens.

Honest limitations

- The seven feature panels (backups, uptime, security, SEO, performance, maintenance, health checks) lock and unlock correctly, but entries are written by the team. Connecting them to automatic sources is a separate job.
- The logo picture in emails still reads 'ETHIXWEB'; all written text now says 'Ethixweb'. Nothing is committed or deployed — all changes sit in the working folder for review.